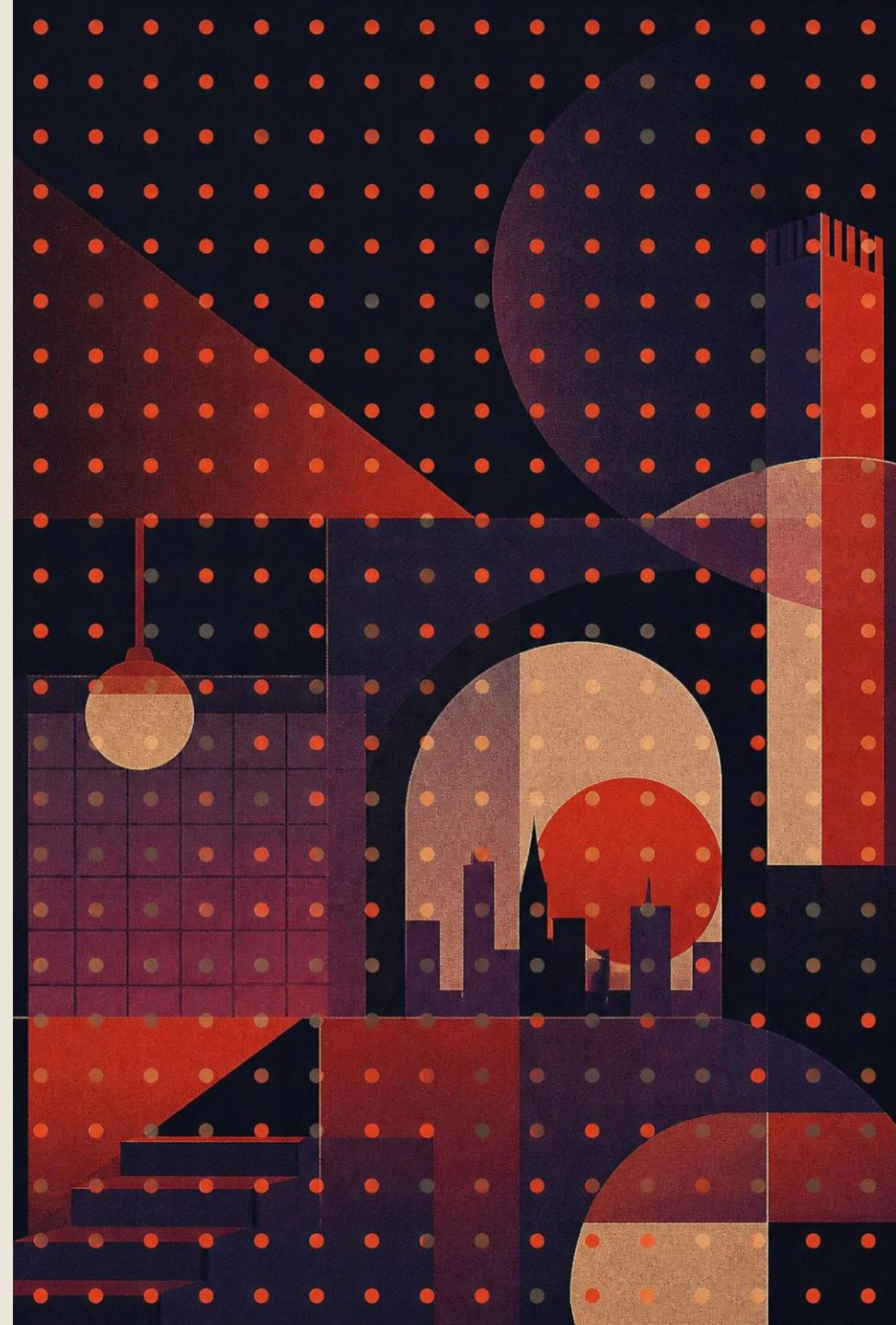


The Thousand and the Ten

What 1,000 small internet businesses reveal about who actually makes money



A thousand small businesses, measured 29 different ways

1,000

Internet businesses tracked

29

Data points per company

262

Currently for sale

What we measured

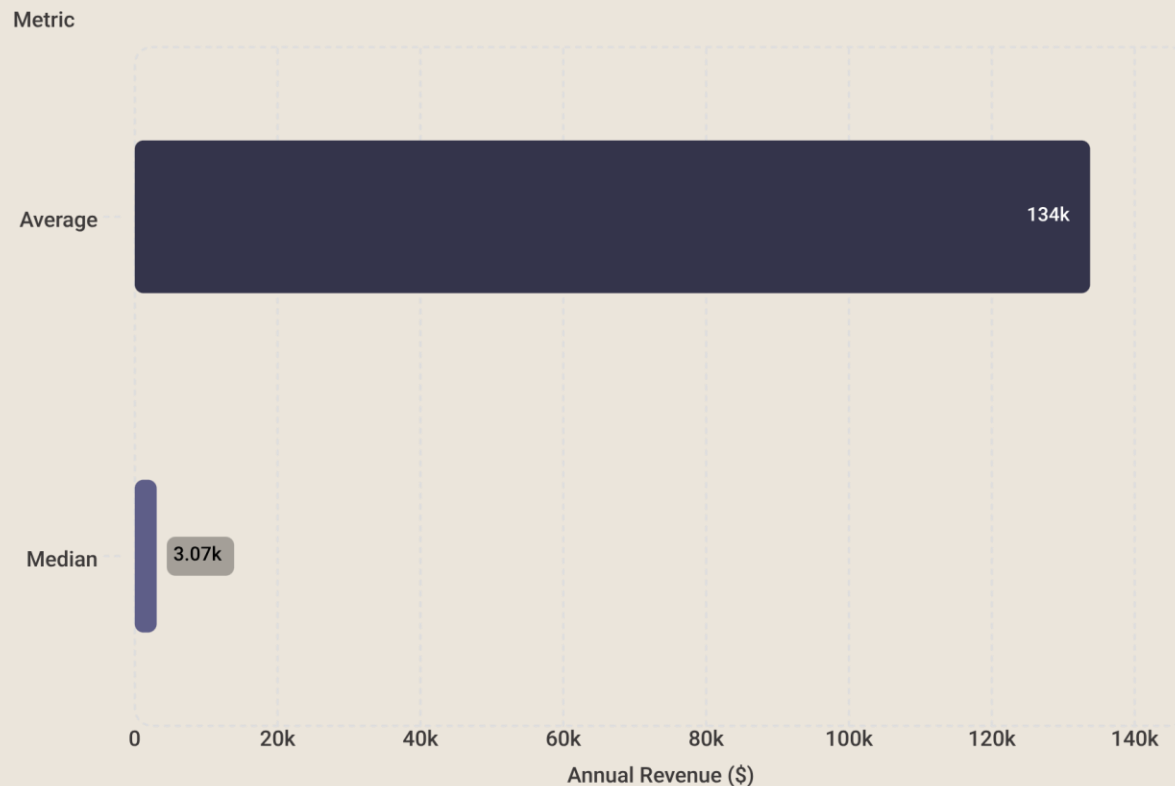
- Revenue, growth, customers, and pricing
- Most are tiny. Some are large. Almost all run by small teams.
- **29,000 facts** across 1,000 companies and 29 data points each



The average company earns \$133,750. The typical company earns \$3,068.

44×

The average is 44 times the median. When the average is that far from the typical, a small group is carrying everything.

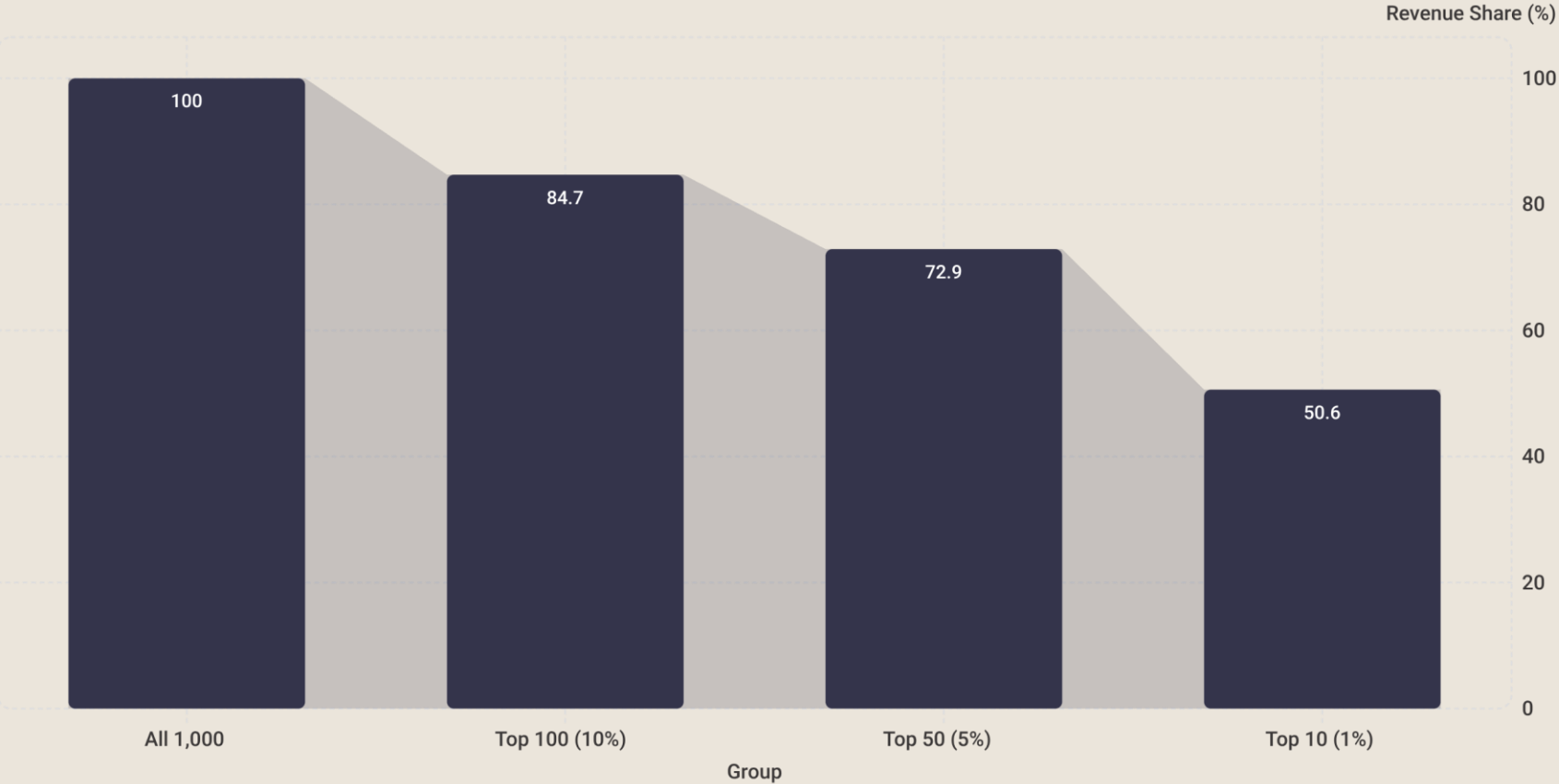


Walk to the middle of 1,000 companies. That company earned \$3,068 last year.

10 companies out of 1,000 earn half of all the money

50.6%

Total conversion rate



❏ The single largest company alone earned \$25,017,876 – 18.7% of the entire market. You only need 10 rows of this spreadsheet to explain half of it.

0.21%

The bottom 500 companies' share of all revenue

\$274,205 combined across a full year. Half the market is, financially speaking, a rounding error.

Inside the bottom half

109 companies

Earned exactly zero

286 companies

Earned between \$1 and \$1,000 for the year

\$274,205

Total earned by bottom 500 combined

If ten companies win everything, what do they do differently?

We compared the top 100 companies against the remaining 900 across every measurable field. Three differences stood out, and one of them contradicts the obvious assumption.

1

Who they sell to

B2B vs B2C

2

How they grow

Subscribers vs followers

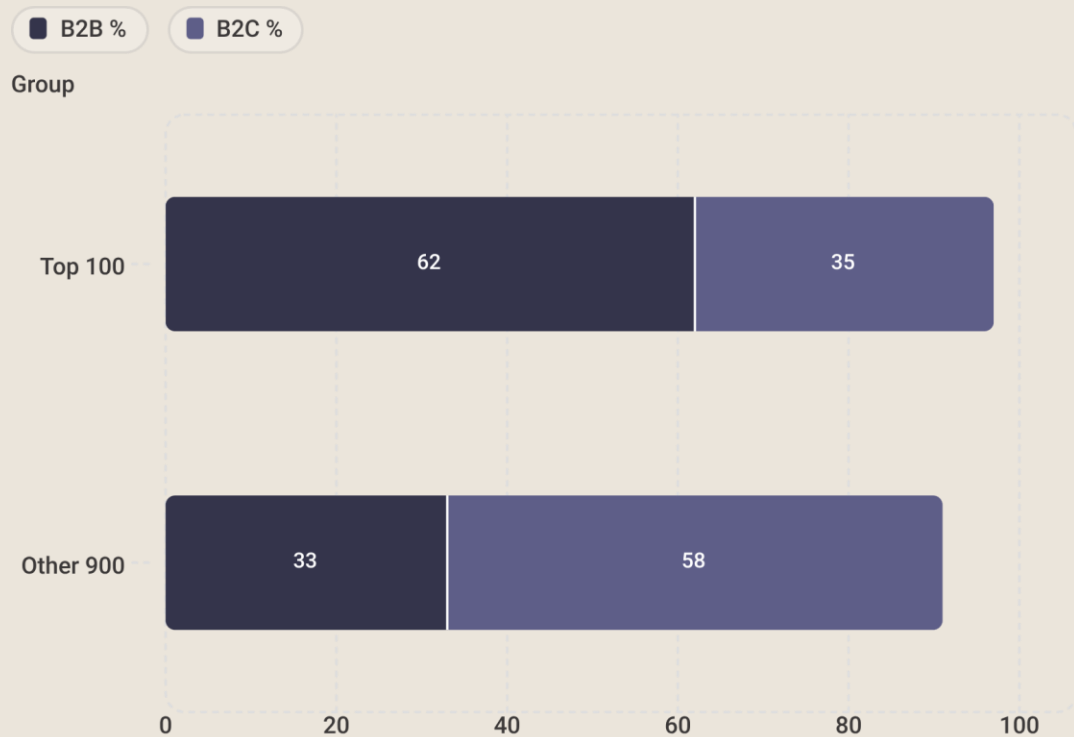
3

What they build

Category vs revenue



The market is mostly consumer apps. The winners are mostly business tools.



The ratio flips completely at the top

- Across all 1,000: 401 sell to consumers, 255 sell to businesses
- Inside the top 100: **62% are B2B**, 35% are B2C
- Inside the other 900: 33% are B2B, **58% are B2C**

Most founders build for consumers. The ones who make money build for companies.

The gap between winners and everyone else is not close

205×

MRR gap

Top 100 median: \$34,936. Other 900
median: \$170.

81×

Subscriber gap

Top 100: 650 paying subscribers. Other
900: 8.

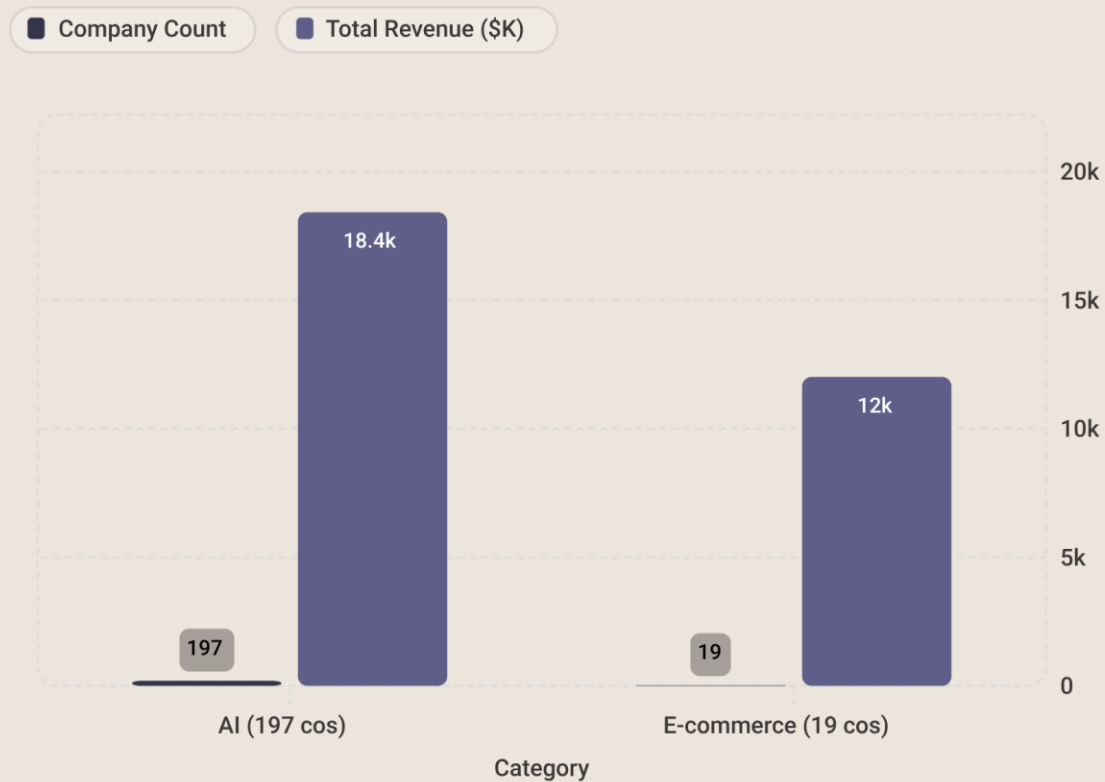
6×

Follower gap

Top 100: 344 Twitter followers. Other 900:
54.

📌 Followers are not the moat. Paying subscribers are.

One in five companies here is an AI company. They earn 14% of the money.



Crowded is not the same as profitable

- AI is the largest category: **197 companies**, roughly 20% of the dataset
- AI earned \$18,428,213 total — about **14% of market revenue**
- AI median annual revenue: \$4,301
- E-commerce, with only 19 companies, earned \$12,018,508 — nearly as much as all 197 AI companies
- Of the top 100 earners, only **15 are AI companies**

American, B2B, and running on Stripe

Companies by region

Europe

293 companies, 16 in top 100

North America

287 companies, **49 in top 100**

Asia-Pacific

127 companies

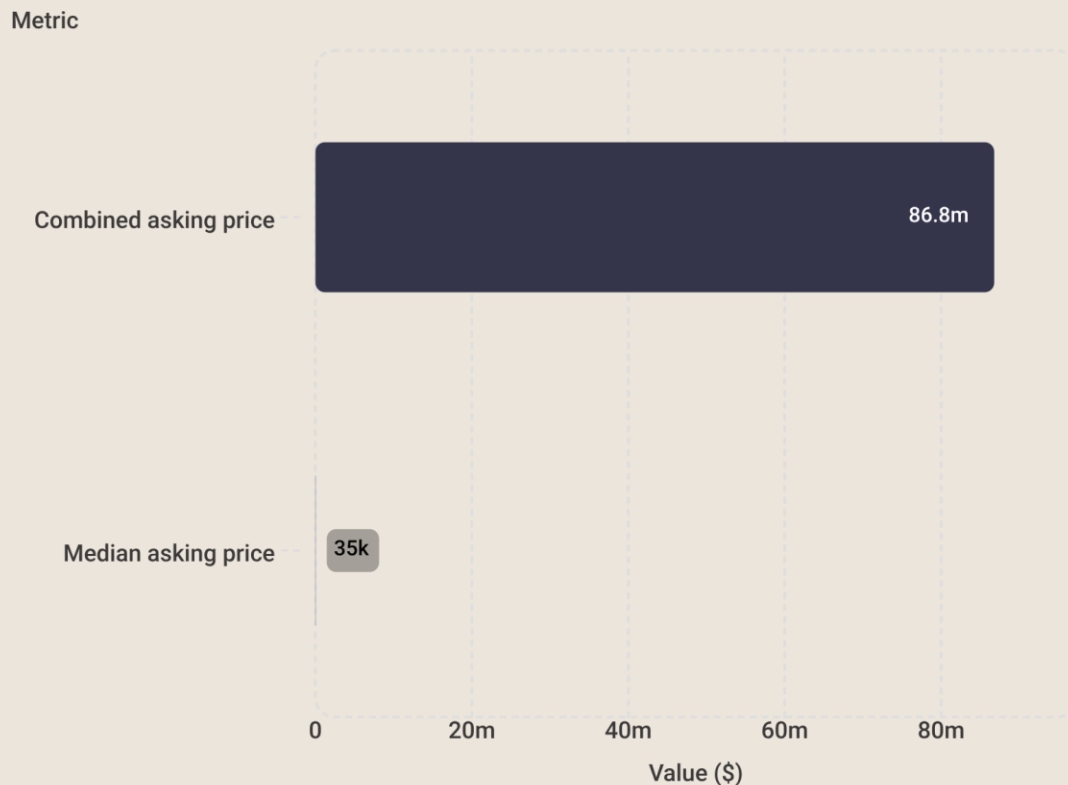
Revenue tells a different story

- US 30-day revenue: **\$9,843,127**
- UK 30-day revenue: \$444,825 — 22 times smaller
- 636 of 1,000 companies use Stripe
- Stripe handles \$13,526,762 of tracked 30-day revenue

Europe has the companies. America has the revenue.



262 businesses are for sale. Some are asking real money for no revenue.



The market for exits

- 262 companies (26%) are listed for sale
- Combined asking price: **\$86,779,245**
- Median asking price: \$35,000
- Median asking multiple: 2.3 times annualised revenue
- **16 listed businesses** have zero recorded 12-month revenue but still carry an asking price

In a long-tail market, most things for sale are from the tail.

What this means

Four things this data says

01

A winner-take-most market

Ten companies hold 50.6% of revenue.
Averages mislead here.

02

Business tools beat consumer apps

B2B is a quarter of all companies but 62% of the top 100.

03

Customers beat followers

Winners have 81x the subscribers but only 6x the followers.

04

Crowded is not profitable

19 e-commerce firms earned two-thirds of what 197 AI firms did.

In a market of a thousand, study the ten.